



Landing Page Vision

Big Sister Foundation

CREATIVE & STRATEGIC BRIEF

April 2026

Prepared for Bolaji — Founder

Drawing on the playbooks of charity: water, Stripe, &Walsh,
Girls Who Code, and the Obama Foundation.

The Real Problem

Every nonprofit has a landing page. Almost none of them earn trust in the first 3 seconds.

In Nigeria — where 75%+ of web traffic is mobile and data costs are real — you don't get a second chance.

“People don't give to organizations. They give to people they believe in, solving a problem they can see.”

SCOTT HARRISON — FOUNDER, CHARITY: WATER

What We're Optimizing For

Trust in 3 Seconds

The #1 barrier to giving in Nigeria is trust. Not awareness, not empathy — trust. Every pixel on this page must answer: “Is this real?”

Emotion → Action

Not just awareness. The page must create a feeling strong enough to convert — whether that's a donation, a follow, or sharing with a friend.

Mobile-First, Data-Light

107M Nigerians are online. 75%+ are on phones. If your page loads in 8 seconds, you've already lost. Every image, animation, and font choice must justify its weight.

The Single Goal

A first-time visitor should be able to understand what you do, trust that it's real, and take one action — in under 60 seconds, on a phone, on a slow network.

Who's in the Room

We're pulling principles from six of the best in the world — each responsible for a different dimension of this page.

SCOTT HARRISON — CHARITY: WATER

Transparency as the product. Harrison proved that showing exactly where every dollar goes isn't a feature — it's the entire brand. His 100% model and GPS-tracked projects are the gold standard. Your public ledger and direct-to-child mapping are the same DNA.

RESHMA SAUJANI — GIRLS WHO CODE

Put the people you serve front and center. GWC's homepage leads with the faces of girls, not logos or stats. The hero image does 80% of the trust-building. BSF should lead with the faces of real children and women, not abstractions.

JESSICA WALSH — &WALSH

Emotional branding through "brand therapy." Walsh's philosophy: design isn't decoration, it's the voice. Every color, typeface, and image should feel like an extension of the founder's personality. The BSF page should feel like talking to Bolaji — warm, direct, real.

OBAMA FOUNDATION DESIGN TEAM

Mission clarity in the first fold. Their homepage hero video + bold banner communicates everything in one breath. No ambiguity, no scrolling required to understand the purpose. A 2025 Webby Award winner for a reason.

BENJAMIN HERSH — STRIPE DESIGN

Animation as information, not decoration. Stripe's team proved that motion should tell you what something does before you read a word. Subtle, purposeful, performance-conscious. Their Intersection Observer approach ensures animations only run when visible — critical for mobile.

LUKE WROBLEWSKI — MOBILE-FIRST PIONEER

Constraints breed clarity. Wroblewski's mobile-first methodology forces you to prioritize ruthlessly. For a Lagos audience on 3G: what's the one thing they need to see, the one thing they need to feel, the one thing they need to do?

Page Architecture

Seven sections. One vertical scroll. Each section has one job. The visitor should never feel lost or overwhelmed.

01 Hero — “The Promise”

What it is: Full-viewport. A single photograph of a real BSF beneficiary looking directly at camera. The iroko tree mark sits quietly top-left. One sentence headline. One CTA button.

The line: Something like “Every child we reach becomes a leader who raises their community.” Not a mission statement — a promise.

Why (Harrison): charity: water uses “gaze following” — a photo where the subject looks toward the headline. Our eye follows theirs. The child's face is the trust signal. The headline is the hook.

PHOTO

1 HEADLINE

1 CTA

02 Social Proof Bar — “The Receipts”

What it is: A slim horizontal strip. Three numbers: children supported, naira tracked publicly, communities reached. No paragraphs. Just data.

Why (Stripe): Stripe's landing pages use a “credibility band” immediately below the hero. Numbers build trust faster than paragraphs. Animate them counting up on scroll (lightweight CSS counters, not JS libraries).

STATS

ANIMATE ON SCROLL

03 Three Pathways — “Who We Serve”

What it is: Three cards, each with a real photo, the pathway name, and one sentence. Difficult Backgrounds. Special Needs. Gifted Children. Tap/click reveals a short story.

Why (Girls Who Code): GWC proves that putting real faces on your categories makes them human, not bureaucratic. Each card should feel like meeting someone, not reading a brochure.

3 CARDS

REAL PHOTOS

TAP TO EXPAND

Page Architecture

04 Transparency Engine — “Follow the Money”

What it is: This is your killer differentiator. A live or simulated view showing: a donor gives → it maps to a specific child → the child’s name, photo, and what the money provides. Visualized as a simple flow diagram or animated connection line.

Why (Harrison): charity: water GPS-tracks every well. You’re doing the same with every naira. This is not a feature to bury in the footer — it’s the centerpiece. Make it interactive. Make it undeniable.

Technical note: Keep this lightweight. A CSS/SVG animation of the flow, not a heavy JS framework. Pre-rendered on server if needed. Must work on 3G.

INTERACTIVE

CORE DIFFERENTIATOR

SVG ANIMATION

05 Bolaji’s Story — “Meet the Big Sister”

What it is: A short, personal section. Photo of Bolaji. 3–4 sentences in first person. Not a bio — a confession. Why this matters to her. Why she couldn’t not do it.

Why (Walsh): Walsh’s “brand therapy” principle — the brand is the founder’s authentic voice. People give to people. This section converts skeptics into believers. charity: water’s “Meet the Founder” page is one of their highest-converting assets.

PERSONAL PHOTO

FIRST PERSON VOICE

06 The Ask — “Choose Your Impact”

What it is: The donation section. Not a generic “Donate Now” — tiered impact levels showing exactly what each amount provides. “\$5,000 = one month of meals.” “\$25,000 = a term of school fees.” Each tier shows the child it helps.

Why (Harrison): charity: water proved that “\$30 gives one person clean water for life” converts 3–5x better than “Donate any amount.” Specificity creates confidence. Confidence creates action.

TIERED GIVING

IMPACT MAPPING

SIMPLE FORM

07 Footer — “The Roots”

What it is: Minimal. Logo mark, tagline, email, social links. A single line: “100% of every donation goes to a child. Our operations are funded separately.” Trust reinforcement, not navigation bloat.

MINIMAL

TRUST LINE

How It Should Feel

“If you swapped the colors into a different brand and it still ‘worked,’ you haven’t made specific enough choices.”

Color: Earthy, Not Corporate

Use the BSF palette exactly as defined. Iroko Green dominates (60%), Cream as canvas (25%), Gold + Terracotta for accents (15%). No gradients. No neon. The palette should feel like red earth, green canopy, warm afternoon light in Lagos.

Typography: Warmth + Authority

Georgia for headlines — it has the gravitas of a serif without feeling institutional. Calibri for body — clean, modern, readable on low-res screens. Consider a single accent use of a handwritten-style font for Bolaji’s personal quote only.

Photography: Real, Not Stock

This is the hardest and most important part. No stock photography. Period. Real photos of real BSF beneficiaries, shot with available light, in their real environments. Eye contact with camera. Dignity, not pity. Joy where it exists. Stillness where it doesn’t.

If you don’t have these photos yet, that is the single most important investment before launch.

Layout: Breath Over Density

Every section gets room to breathe. Generous whitespace (the Apple principle). One idea per viewport. No sidebar clutter. The page should feel calm and confident, like someone who doesn’t need to shout.

Icons & Illustration: Minimal

Use icons sparingly — only where they replace text that would slow a mobile reader. Prefer simple line icons in Iroko Green. No 3D illustrations, no cartoon characters. This is a serious mission with a warm voice, not a startup trying to seem friendly.

The “Iroko” Visual Thread

Weave the tree motif subtly throughout: the mark in the nav, a faint canopy silhouette as a section divider, root-like lines connecting the donation flow. Never heavy-handed. Think watermark, not wallpaper.

Movement With Purpose

“The best animation tells you what something does before you read a word.”

— Stripe Design Team

What to Animate

Hero Entrance

Photo fades in. Headline types or slides up. CTA button appears last. Total: 1.2 seconds. Creates a moment of arrival, not a loading screen.

Stats Counter

Numbers count up from zero when scrolled into view. CSS counters + Intersection Observer. No external library. Completes in 1.5 seconds.

Transparency Flow

The donation-to-child mapping: an animated SVG line that draws itself, connecting “Your ₦5,000” to a child’s name and photo. The signature moment of the whole page. Keep it to 2–3 seconds.

Section Reveals

Each section fades up slightly (translateY: 20px → 0, opacity: 0 → 1) as it enters the viewport. Subtle, consistent, never bouncy.

What NOT to Animate

Parallax scrolling

Kills performance on low-end Android phones. Adds nothing to trust or conversion.

Auto-playing video

Burns data. Often blocked on mobile. Replace with a high-quality still + optional play button.

Hover-dependent interactions

75% of your audience has no hover state. Design for tap. Period.

Loading spinners / skeleton screens

If you need them, your page is too heavy. Target: <3 seconds first meaningful paint on 3G.

Technical Stack for Motion

- CSS animations + transitions (primary)
- Intersection Observer API (scroll triggers)
- Inline SVG for the donation flow line
- No GSAP, no Lottie, no Three.js — too heavy

The Words That Convert

Voice Principles

First Person, Not Third

“We feed 200 children” not “The foundation provides nutritional support to 200 beneficiaries.” Bureaucratic language kills trust. Speak like a human being talking to another human being.

Specific, Not Abstract

“\$5,000 buys Amina school supplies for a term” not “Your generous donation helps fund educational programs.” Every claim should be falsifiable. That’s what makes it trustworthy.

Empowering, Not Pitying

“Future leaders growing up in difficult circumstances” not “Helpless children in need.” The people you serve have agency. The page should reflect that.

Copy Framework

Hero Headline Options

“Every child we reach becomes someone who raises their community.”

“You give to one child. That child raises a village.”

“See exactly where your money goes. Every naira. Every child.”

CTA Button Language

Not “Donate Now” (generic, pressure). Try: **“Choose a Child to Support”** or **“See Where Your Money Goes”** — action-oriented, curiosity-driven, trust-building.

Microcopy Matters

Under the donate button: “100% goes to the child. We publish every transaction.” Under the email signup: “Updates only. We respect your inbox.” Small words do heavy lifting.

What to Have & What to Kill

✓ Include

Real photography of beneficiaries (with consent). This is the single highest-impact investment you can make.

Live donation tracker or public ledger preview. Even a static mockup of the interface signals radical transparency.

Tiered giving with naira amounts. “₦5,000 / ₦15,000 / ₦50,000” with specific impact descriptions.

Founder’s personal note. 3–4 sentences. First person. A photo where she looks approachable.

WhatsApp share button. In Nigeria, WhatsApp is the internet. Make sharing frictionless.

Lazy-loaded, compressed images. WebP format, responsive srcset. Target total page weight under 800KB.

Single “sticky” CTA on mobile. A persistent bottom bar with the primary action, so it’s always reachable.

✗ Kill

Stock photography. Nothing destroys trust faster than a Getty image of “diverse children smiling.” If you don’t have real photos, use the logo mark and typography until you do.

Hamburger menu. You have 4–5 nav items max. Show them. Hidden navigation is abandoned navigation.

Pop-ups or modals on entry. Especially on mobile. No cookie banners, no email pop-ups, no “subscribe” overlays. Let the page earn attention first.

Carousel / image slider. Studies show less than 1% of users click past the first slide. Use a single, powerful image instead.

Heavy JS frameworks for a landing page. No React, no Next.js. Static HTML + CSS + minimal vanilla JS. Fastest possible load.

Mission-speak jargon. “Synergizing community empowerment through sustainable intervention paradigms” = instant close tab.

Built for Lagos, Not Silicon Valley

Performance Targets

First Meaningful Paint

< 2.5 seconds on 3G

This is non-negotiable. 53% of mobile users abandon pages that take >3 seconds to load.

Total Page Weight

< 800 KB

Images compressed to WebP. Fonts subsetting. No external CSS frameworks. Every kilobyte costs your users money.

Lighthouse Score

95+ across all metrics

Performance, accessibility, best practices, SEO. Test on a real mid-range Android device, not a MacBook Pro.

Technical Approach

Static HTML + CSS. No build tools, no hydration, no client-side routing. A single index.html that works everywhere.

System font stack first. Load Georgia only for headings. Use font-display: swap so text appears instantly.

Images: WebP with JPEG fallback. Responsive srcset for mobile (640px), tablet (1024px), desktop (1600px). Lazy-load everything below the fold.

Hosting: Edge CDN. Cloudflare Pages or Vercel — free tier, global CDN, sub-100ms TTFB in Lagos.

Analytics: Plausible or Umami. Privacy-respecting, <1KB script. No Google Analytics (45KB+ and GDPR concerns).

Payment: Paystack. Nigerian-native. Supports cards, bank transfer, USSD. One integration, every payment method your audience uses.

The Three Investments That Matter Most

You can build a beautiful page in a weekend. But these three things determine whether it actually works. They can't be faked or fast-tracked.

1 Photography

Hire a local Lagos photographer for one day. Shoot real beneficiaries (with full consent and dignity). You need: 1 hero image (child looking at camera), 3 pathway portraits, 1 founder portrait, 2–3 activity shots. This single day of shooting will power your landing page, social media, and pitch decks for the next year.

Budget estimate: ₦150,000–300,000 for a good Lagos-based photographer, full day with editing.

2 Copywriting

Write Bolaji's personal story. 150 words, first person. Write one sentence for each pathway. Write the headline. Write the CTA. Write the microcopy under every button. This is a half-day exercise, but it needs to be done with care — every word on this page is load-bearing.

3 Donation Infrastructure

Set up Paystack (or similar) with the tiered giving model. Test it on mobile. Test it on slow networks. Test it with real people who aren't tech-savvy. The donation flow is where intention becomes action — if it breaks or confuses, nothing else on the page matters.

“The page is not the product. The trust is the product. The page is just how you deliver it.”



Now let's build it.

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Rooted. Present. Protective.